The Moon · Pupil Resources

Learning goal: I can explain how the Moon orbits the Earth and why we see different Moon phases.

Arrival Questions (In your book)

1. What planet does the Moon orbit?

2. About how many days does the Moon take to orbit the Earth once?

3. Does the Moon make its own light or reflect sunlight?

4. Can you ask an adult to help?

Starter Question

Why do we see a New Moon when the Moon is between the Sun and the Earth?

A. The sunlit half of the Moon faces away from Earth, and the unlit dark half faces us.

B. The Sun switches off for one night each month.

C. Clouds cover the Moon in space.

Method Strip

1. Place the Sun card at the top of your desk and the Earth Orbit Mat in the centre.

2. Notice that every Space-View Moon card has the half facing the Sun coloured white (lit). STOP AND CHECK.

3. Place the 8 Earth-View Phase cards around the orbit ring to show what a person on Earth sees.

4. Trace the cycle anticlockwise from New Moon (Day 0)

to Full Moon (Day 14) and back to Day 28.

5. Draw and explain New Moon, First Quarter, and Full Moon in your book.

Exit Ticket

How many days does the Moon take to orbit the Earth once?

Where does the light we see from the Moon come from?

Explain why we see a Full Moon when the Moon is on the opposite side of Earth from the Sun.